SOUTHERN THREE-BANDED ARMADILLO

Tolypeutes matacus

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UNITED STATES DEPT. OF AGRI.

This animal is a teacher, not an attraction.

The keeper guides.
You observe. Do not touch.

Cameras in use. Federal penalties apply.

What can it see, hear, or feel?
Its nose smells bugs under the leaves, its ears hear small sounds, and it feels steps shake the ground.

Where does it live — and why?
It lives in dry bushy land, where logs and brush give it a safe place to hide.

How does it send messages?
It is very quiet, grunts softly while looking for food, and makes a sharp click when it rolls up.

What does it do when something changes?
When danger comes near, it rolls into a hard ball — it is the only armadillo that can do this.

How does it learn?
A young one follows its mother, learns which logs hold ants, and practices rolling up when it is small.

How does it have babies?
A mother usually has one baby, with a soft pink shell that gets hard over the next few weeks.

What are its limits?
It cannot dig its own burrow, so it needs other animals' holes or brush to rest in.

What does this teach us?
Staying still inside strong armor is another way to be safe when you cannot run fast.

Think About This:

If you could roll into a perfect hard ball, when would you choose to stay and when would you run?

Verification Door

Why does a three-banded armadillo roll up instead of digging to escape danger?

Its hard shell closes into a perfect ball, so staying still inside armor keeps it safer than running away.

What a living thing can sense becomes its reality.
Environment shapes design.